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Minoru Higa

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Research Interests

Environmental, Labor, and Development Economics

Current Position

Assistant Professor (tenure-track)
School of Management, Universidad de los Andes — 2023-

Education

Simon Fraser University (SFU)	Ph.D. in Economics	2023
University of California, Santa Barbara (UCSB)	M.A. in Economics	2015
Tilburg University (cum laude)	MSc. in Economics	2011
Pontificia Universidad Catolica del Peru (PUCP)	BSc. in Economics	2008

References

Prof. Fernando Aragon	Prof. Hendrik Wolff	Prof. Kevin Schnepel
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Journal Publications

"Is it Too Hot to Work? Evidence from Peru" *Environment and Development Economics,* 2025:1-20.

"COVID-19 Impacts on Amazon Deforestation" with Jerico Fiestas and Javier Montoya. *Trees, Forests and People,* 2025.

"The Persistent Effects of COVID-19 on Labor Outcomes: Evidence from Peru" with Carlos Ospino and Fernando Aragon. *Applied Economics Letters,* 2023.

Research in Progress

"Traffic Congestion and Labor Supply: Evidence from Smartphone Data"

"Who Works Outdoors? Using Machine Learning, Text-as-Data, and Large Language Models (LLMs)" with Jose Incio and Carlos Ospino.

"Climate Shocks and Informal Transitions" with Nicolas Guida-Johnson.

"The effect of a decline in crime concentration on deforestation: Evidence from Colombia" with Rodrigo Londono van Rutten.

"Unexpected Population Growth and Environmental Quality: Evidence from Facebook Data in Colombia" with Pablo Ordonez and Julieth Santamaria.

Prior Research Experience

SFU, Research Assistant (Prof. F. Aragon, Prof. P. Mouganie)	2018 – 2021
Inter-American Development Bank (IDB), Research Consultant	2016 – 2017
IDB and GRADE, Research Consultant	2013 – 2014
International Labor Organization (ILO), Research Consultant	2012 – 2013, 2014
Innovations for Poverty Action (IPA), Intern	2012

	Ministry of Labor, Research Advisor to the Deputy Minister	2011 – 2012
	Carleton University, Research Assistant (Prof. A. Dammert)	2009 – 2010
	PUCP, Research Assistant (Prof. J. Rodriguez)	2008 – 2010

Teaching Experience

Instructor, *Universidad de los Andes* — 2023-

- ADMI1301: Intro to Programming (w/Python)

Instructor, *Simon Fraser University* — 2022

- ECON260: Environmental Economics

Teaching Assistant, *Simon Fraser University* — 2017 – Present

- ECON836: Applied Econometrics
- ECON334: Data Visualization and Economic Analysis
- ECON333: Statistical Analysis of Economic Data
- ECON383: Environmental Economics and Policy
- ECON260: Environmental Economics
- ECON220W: Communications in Economics
- ECON201: Microeconomic Theory I: Competitive Behavior
- ECON103: Principles of Microeconomics

Presentations at Conferences

International Transportation Economics Association Conference, LAERE congress	2025
EAERE Summer Conference	2024
Pacific Conference for Development Economics (PacDev), AERE Summer Conference, Emerging Mobility Scholars Conference, 20th International Economic Association World Congress, LACEA and LAMES Conference.	2023
CREEA Annual Conference, TWEEDS.	2022
UNU-WIDER Development Conference, NAREA Annual Meeting, Canadian Economics Association (CEA) Annual Meeting, CIREQ conference for Climate Change.	2021
Environment for Development (EfD) Annual Meeting, SEEDS Annual Workshop.	2020
UC Berkeley/Sloan Summer School in Environmental and Energy Economics (Egg-timer presenter).	2019

Honors, Grants and Scholarships

Shiva and Elizabeth Nanda Fellowship, *SFU*	2022
GSS Professional Development Grant, *SFU*	2022
SFU Data Fellowships: AI Essentials Grant, *SFU*	2021
Lang Wong Memorial Endowment Scholarship, *SFU*	2020
Student Community Engagement Competition Grant, *SFU*	2020, 2022
Travel and Research Award, *SFU*	2020, 2022
Graduate Fellowship, *SFU*	2017 – 2022
Special Graduate Entrance Scholarship, *SFU*	2017
Departmental Andron Fellowship, *UCSB*	2014 – 2015
Departmental Block Grant Fellowship, *UCSB*	2014 – 2015
Tilburg University Scholarship	2010 – 2011
Annual Research Grant Contest, *1st place, CIES and IDRC*	2009

	Young Environmental Envoy, *thesis finalist, UNEP-Bayer*	2008

Professional Service	**Referee**: Latin American Economic Review, Oxford Development Studies **Conference Reviewer**: 2024 and 2025 NAREA (Northeastern Agricultural and Resource Economics Association) Annual Meeting; 2026 World Congress of Environmental and Resource Economists; 2026 BALAS Conference
Computing Skills	R, Python, SQL, GIS, Amazon AWS, Stata, and LaTeX
Languages	English (fluent), Spanish (native)
Volunteering and Engagement	Mentor: Econthaki's mentoring program to promote diversity in economic research in LAC. — 2022 Co-organizer and grant writer: Math Walks, Empowering the village, Connecting to Indigenous Culture. — 2020, 2022 Diverse roles: mentoring microentrepreneurs of scarce resources (*Accion Emprendedora*), help spreading scholarship information for low-income students (*Ankay*), building dwellings for poor families in Chile (*Techo*). — Before Ph.D.